PSJA ISD AI Guidebook: Data and Student Privacy Passages

Excerpted verbatim from the *Pharr-San Juan-Alamo ISD AI Guidebook* (Version 1, updated September 2026). Page numbers match the guidebook's own page numbering. Passages marked [graphic] were transcribed from images in the original.

Guiding Principles: Safety and Privacy

Source: page 4

SAFEGUARDING — Safety and Privacy. We strictly select and utilize AI tools that meet rigorous data privacy and digital footprint standards.

[graphic] SAFETY AND PRIVACY: Protecting student data and identity.

Privacy & Security

Source: page 5

To safeguard student privacy, ensure instructional integrity, and boost professional productivity, please follow these guidelines for district-approved AI tools (accessible via your district login). Do not use non-approved AI resources for any work-related activities.

Student Privacy & Data Protection (FERPA Compliance)

In accordance with the Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA) and PSJA ISD Board Policy FL (LEGAL), safeguarding student data is a critical legal requirement.

Under no circumstances should staff enter, upload, paste, or describe identifiable student information into public AI tools or prompts. Treat prompts as data leaving district systems. Even partial information combined with context can make a student identifiable.

Examples of Strictly Prohibited Information:

- Basic Identifiers: Student names (first and last), Student ID numbers, dates of birth, home addresses, or parent/guardian names.
- Protected Records: Social Security numbers, disciplinary records, health/medical information, or human resources/payroll info.
- Academic & Support Data: Grades connected to an identifiable student, or Special Education (IEP) and Section 504 details tied to a specific student.

Incident Reporting Protocol

If you suspect a data exposure, a security breach, or the misuse of an AI tool, you must report it immediately to mitigate data risk.

- Report to: PSJA ISD IT Helpdesk
- Submission Channels: Helpdesk Portal Link | helpdesk@psjaisd.us

Staff AI Expectations: Personal AI Account Policy

Source: page 6

While PSJA ISD requires district-managed credentials for standard work to ensure legal compliance (CIPA, COPPA, FERPA, PPRA), it recognizes that staff may use personal premium accounts (e.g., ChatGPT Plus, Gemini Advanced) for advanced features. When doing so, staff must strictly adhere to data privacy guardrails: never enter student Personally Identifiable Information (PII) or confidential district data into an AI account.

Staff AI Expectations: Staff Security Protocols

Source: page 6

To ensure network security and data loss prevention, all staff members must adhere to the following operational guardrails:

- **District-Managed Accounts Only:** Always log in using official PSJA ISD Microsoft 365 or Google Workspace credentials. Never use personal emails or accounts for district business.
- **Approved Storage Systems:** Store and share district documents only within approved environments (Google Drive, SharePoint, OneDrive, Teams). Follow all existing sharing and permission rules.
- **No Unapproved Add-ons:** Do not install AI browser extensions, add-ons, or connectors (for Google Workspace or Office 365) without explicit IT administrative approval.
- **Third-Party App Restriction:** Staff are prohibited from authorizing third-party apps or granting AI tools permission to access district accounts and data sets.
- **Managed Endpoints Only:** If an authorized AI tool requires file uploads or document access, it must only be accessed on managed district devices equipped with active endpoint protection.
- **Basic Identifiers:** Passwords, access tokens, or any login credentials for district-managed systems.

Staff AI Expectations: District Approved AI Tools (excerpt)

Source: page 7

Information Technology Department maintains a vetted list of AI domains and applications. AI tools and related web traffic will be actively logged and inappropriate content will be blocked on district networks and managed devices.

[graphic] **Before using any AI tool, confirm:**

- 1. You are using a district-approved AI tool and a district-managed account.
- 2. No passwords, access tokens, or login credentials are included.
- 3. No student-identifiable information is included.
- 4. No confidential staff information is included.

Student AI Expectations: PSJA Student AI Quick Guide (excerpt)

Source: page 8 [graphic]

DON'T: No private info (ID, name, address)

The Privacy Shield: Never enter your Full Name, Student ID, or Home Address into an AI tool

Using AI Responsibly: Examples of Misuse (excerpt)

Source: page 10

Privacy Violations — Entering or sharing personal, confidential, or sensitive information about self or others into AI platforms without authorization.

Security Violations / Hacking Attempts — Using AI to attempt unauthorized access to school systems, accounts, or restricted data.